

Chapter 3

Yin Lingzhu saw You Xiaoxiao come in and closed the browser on her phone.

"Doctor, if I don't mark anyone else, is there any way for me to survive?" Yin Lingzhu's eyebrows were tightly furrowed, her lips slightly pressed together.

You Xiaoxiao hadn't expected her to ask this question. "Marking is the simplest and most effective method, but there is a specialized device that can help you release pheromones."

Hearing the latter half of her statement, Yin Lingzhu felt relieved, and her eyebrows gradually relaxed.

It was good that there were other options.

"However, this machine is still in development, and it's extremely expensive," You Xiaoxiao added.

"It costs roughly twice your breach of contract penalty."

In just a few seconds, Yin Lingzhu's emotions went through extreme highs and lows.

Hearing You Xiaoxiao's last sentence, her entire being radiated an aura of hopelessness, and her shoulders drooped powerlessly.

"But why don't you want to mark anyone?" You Xiaoxiao still didn't understand, her tone full of confusion.

She had investigated Yin Lingzhu's background. She had many ambiguous relationships and seemed like a standard scumbag Alpha.

"Marking someone means taking responsibility for them." Yin Lingzhu lay on the bed, her arms falling limply, but her tone was serious and sincere.

"Casually marking others is irresponsible to both parties." Yin Lingzhu thought about the information she had just researched, her tone heavy.

"You really do seem like a good Alpha after all." You Xiaoxiao sighed and left the hospital room again.

Yin Lingzhu watched her departing figure, her pure black pupils flickering between light and dark.

You Xiaoxiao was obviously problematic, but she didn't want to investigate deeply right now. At present, she wanted to know if there was a way to survive.

But she really didn't know what to do now. If she had transmigrated earlier, there might have been ways to earn money, but now...

Yin Lingzhu let out a helpless long sigh, lamenting the cruel tricks of fate.

You Xiaoxiao, who had left the room, called Yan Si. "You need to come to the hospital immediately."

Yan Si couldn't understand why You Xiaoxiao was so insistent on having her marry that someone.

Yan Si hadn't remembered Yin Lingzhu's name.

"I'm not going. My mental state is very stable right now." Yan Si refused with a flat tone, flipping through a script in her hands.

"Your mental state is stable? Stable my ass! I'm your doctor - don't I understand your physical condition?" You Xiaoxiao's tone was urgent, mixed with worry.

You Xiaoxiao paced back and forth in the innermost part of the corridor, extremely anxious.

She looked around, confirming no one was there before speaking.

You Xiaoxiao explained the pros and cons clearly, telling Yan Si to think carefully.

"I can't keep covering for you at the hospital much longer." After saying this final sentence, she hung up the phone.

After that, You Xiaoxiao walked determinedly toward the hospital room.

Yan Si stared at the black screen of her phone, her mind filled with countless thoughts.

After a long while, she put down the script, took her car keys, and left.

From the moment You Xiaoxiao returned, her face was written with internal struggle, making Yin Lingzhu find it quite amusing.

"Doctor, if you have something to say, just say it." Yin Lingzhu couldn't help but speak up.

"Then I'll be direct." You Xiaoxiao sat in the chair, her expression grave.

"I want to introduce you to a marriage partner."

Yin Lingzhu's mind went blank for an instant, and her action of reaching for her water cup also paused.

She adjusted her state and brought the cup to her lips. "I don't want to get married right now, and I'm not in a position to marry."

Toward her good friend, You Xiaoxiao was earnest in her persuasion, but she didn't have such patience with Yin Lingzhu.

"Whether you agree or not, you have to agree." You Xiaoxiao's attitude was firm, her eyes staring directly at Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu met her gaze, her hand gripping the water cup tightly.

"Doctor, are you planning to threaten me?"

"You only have this one path." You Xiaoxiao's tone was impatient, her fingertip tapping against the bedside table.

A dangerous atmosphere permeated the hospital room.

Seeing her firm attitude, Yin Lingzhu tried to persuade her again. "I don't understand - are Alphas really so rare that it has to be me?"

You Xiaoxiao looked at her strangely upon hearing this. "S-level Alphas are naturally precious, and ones like you without any background are even rarer."

"Today, you have two paths before you. First, marriage."

"And the second?"

"Second, do you know how many people who underwent secondary differentiation have died?"
You Xiaoxiao smiled lightly.

"Think it over carefully." Having said this, she had no patience to continue negotiating with Yin Lingzhu and got up to leave.

Yin Lingzhu was contemplating her choices and didn't notice You Xiaoxiao's movement. She was preparing to place her water cup on the bedside table.

In that instant, the cup she was setting down collided with the person getting up, and warm water spilled onto You Xiaoxiao's arm.

"I'm sorry, I'm sorry." Yin Lingzhu apologized repeatedly, pressing tissues against the wet sleeve.

You Xiaoxiao didn't dodge, letting her wipe.

"Maliciously damaging medical staff clothing - do you know how much you'll have to compensate?"
You Xiaoxiao looked at her, now having another excuse.

"Fine, fine, fine, Doctor, I'll compensate you for the clothes." Yin Lingzhu lowered her head, wiping the sleeve while saying this.

"Creak—" The sound of the door being pushed open attracted both people's attention.

Yin Lingzhu stared blankly at the person entering.

The newcomer wore a baseball cap that covered most of her face, revealing only beautiful lips - red with a hint of pink, displaying a crystalline luster. Her hair gently rested on her shoulders.

"Nice to meet you. My name is Yan Si." Yan Si's lips curved upward as she walked to Yin Lingzhu's bedside, introducing herself very gently to Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu seemed to have become foolish, staring blankly as she approached and extended her hand.

The hand hung in the air, waiting for another hand to meet it.

"Hello, hello, my name is Yin Lingzhu." Yin Lingzhu disregarded her posture and hurriedly clasped the offered hand.

She spoke hurriedly, afraid that Yan Si might form a bad impression of her.

"Yan Si is your marriage partner." You Xiaoxiao took the opportunity to say.

Hearing You Xiaoxiao's voice and looking at Yan Si before her, Yin Lingzhu's face and neck turned completely red.

Thump! Thump! Thump!

Her heart beat violently at that moment, as if it wanted to jump out of her body.

Her eardrums echoed with the sound of her heartbeat, one after another, destroying Yin Lingzhu's rationality.

"Do you like me?" She heard Yan Si ask her.

Yin Lingzhu's face turned another shade redder, as if blood could drip from it.

The heat in her cheeks prevented her from thinking. She stared blankly at Yan Si, murmuring, "I like you."

After saying this, Yin Lingzhu regretted it. Saying she liked someone she'd just met for the first time - would she think she was frivolous?

Yan Si leaned forward, suddenly drawing closer to Yin Lingzhu. "Can we get married?"

"Yes." Yin Lingzhu nodded mechanically.

Yan Si moved even closer, revealing her face beneath the cap.

Her eyes seemed to contain a layer of water, looking at Yin Lingzhu softly, the black mole at the corner of her eye appearing alluring.

"Then can we get married tomorrow?" Her voice carried temptation, speaking softly like whispers between lovers.

"Yes." Yin Lingzhu made the same motion as before.

Yin Lingzhu felt warmth that didn't belong to her - coming from Yan Si's body.

The intense fragrance of roses filled her nostrils.

She was surrounded by Yan Si's presence.

She could sense that her state wasn't right, but she had no way to return to her normal condition.

Now her mind was completely filled with Yan Si.

"Then I won't disturb your rest." Yan Si said while pulling back the distance between herself and Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu continued nodding. "Okay."

After meeting Yan Si, her body could only perform simple actions.

"If I'd known it would be this simple, I wouldn't have gone through all that trouble." You Xiaoxiao said to Yan Si in the corridor.

"Before you came, she was ready to die rather than submit."

"After you arrived, she lost three souls and seven spirits¹."

You Xiaoxiao marveled at Yan Si's charm.

"Marriage with her doesn't seem to benefit me much." Yan Si said doubtfully.

She now showed none of the seductive appearance from moments ago, her entire being cold and aloof.

"Your mental power hasn't been released - you're relying entirely on suppressants." You Xiaoxiao stopped walking.

"Besides, she underwent secondary differentiation to S-level. The news is currently suppressed, but if word gets out, how many people will compete for her?"

"Marrying her is the best solution. It can shut others up, and your family has been pressuring you about this - it solves everything at once."

You Xiaoxiao said a lot, all explaining the importance of the matter to Yan Si.

The sound of their footsteps resumed in the corridor.

After Yan Si left the room, Yin Lingzhu, having regained her senses, let out a loud cry and buried herself under the covers.

What had she just done?

After a moment, she poked her head out again, breathing deeply.

Her face was still deathly red, but her eyes were bright and sparkling as she replayed the scene in her mind.

She decided to return to her rental apartment immediately to get her household registration book².

Marriage!

Footnotes: ¹ "Lost three souls and seven spirits" - A Chinese idiom (丢了三魂七魄) meaning to be completely stunned or bewildered, as if one's soul has left their body.

² Household registration book (户口本) - An official document in China that records family members and is required for marriage registration.